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E1 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 12: Listening to short conversations and talking about them – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to follow a very short conversation, answer a yes/no and a detail question about it, and then talk with a partner about the same topic. This is the full shape of Task 4.

Materials: Handout E1-12A, one per learner. YES and NO cards. Four place signs for the walls: *college, doctor, market, home*. The teacher's scripts below. For the dialogues, use a strong learner or a colleague as the second voice if you can.

Activity 1: Where are they? (20 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Put the four place signs on four walls. Check the words with a quick mime for each.
2. Read one line at a time. Learners point to the wall, or walk there if space allows: "Your class is in Room 6." "What is the problem?" "How much are the apples?" "Dinner is ready." "Take this medicine." "Two kilos of rice, please." "Open your books." "Where is my phone?"
3. After each, ask which word helped. Board the key words under each place.
4. Pairs say one more thing people say in each place. Hear several.

Activity 2: Two conversations (30 minutes)

1. Tell learners the routine: first time, listen for yes or no; second time, listen for one thing.
2. Read Script A twice. Ask the yes/no question. Cards up, then the short answer together.
3. Give the detail question, then read once more. Learners write the answer in section A of the handout. Check.
4. Repeat with Script B. Ask what the problem is. The question says *headache* and the man says *cough*, so the answer is no.
5. Read both scripts again while learners fill the gaps in section B. Check by reading together.
6. Ask learners to answer aloud in full: "No, he doesn't. He has a cough."

Activity 3: Say it yourselves (25 minutes)

1. Pairs read Script A from section B, then swap roles.
2. Substitution. Board three things to change: the name, the room number, *upstairs* to *downstairs*. Pairs do the dialogue again with their own details.
3. Pairs read Script B and swap. Then change the problem and the number: *a headache, a cold, a sore throat; one time, two times, three times*.
4. Three pairs perform one changed dialogue each. The class answers one yes/no question that you ask about it.

Activity 4: Talk about it (25 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Remind learners that after listening, the assessor asks easy questions about the topic, and the two learners talk.
2. Revise the four phrases from Lesson 3 with gestures: *I like… I don't like… What about you? Me too.* Add: *because it is good, cheap, near, nice.*
3. Model with a learner on the topic of Script A: "Do you like your college?" "Yes, I do. I like my class because it is friendly. What about you?"
4. Pairs talk about the questions in section C. Rule: every answer ends with a question to the partner.
5. Hear four pairs. Praise every *because* and every *What about you?*

Activity 5: Exam mode (20 minutes)

1. Pairs, A and B. No writing.
2. Read Script C twice. As answer the yes/no question to their partner; Bs answer the detail question. Confirm aloud.

3. Read Script D twice. Swap.
4. Ask the discussion question to the whole class. Pairs talk for one minute.
5. Close: “First listen for…?” “Yes or no.” “Then listen for…?” “One thing.” “Then…?” “Talk to my partner.”

Teacher’s scripts

Script A (college).

- A: Hello. Are you a new student?
- B: Yes, I am. My name is Hana.
- A: Welcome, Hana. Your class is in Room 6.
- B: Thank you. Is it upstairs?
- A: Yes, it is.
- Yes/no: Is Hana a new student? (Yes, she is.)
- Detail: Which room is her class in? (Room 6.)

Script B (doctor).

- A: Good morning. What is the problem?
- B: I have a bad cough.
- A: Take this medicine two times a day.
- B: Thank you, doctor.
- Yes/no: Does the man have a headache? (No, he doesn’t.)
- Detail: How many times a day does he take the medicine? (Two times.)

Script C (in the street).

- A: Hi Sara. Where are you going?
- B: I’m going to the market.
- A: What do you want to buy?
- B: Fish and rice.
- Yes/no: Is Sara going to college? (No, she isn’t.)
- Detail: What does she want to buy? (Fish and rice.)

Script D (at home). I live in a small flat. I live with my brother. He is a bus driver. On Sunday we cook together. I like Sunday.

- Yes/no: Does the speaker live with a brother? (Yes.)
- Detail: What do they do on Sunday? (They cook together.)
- Discussion: Where do you buy food? What do you do on Sunday?

Answer key, Lesson 12

- **Section A:** Yes, she is. Room 6. No, he doesn’t. Two times.
- **Section B:** student, 6; problem, cough, two.